

Note 13.2 Integrals of Vector Functions; Projectile Motion

Integrals of Vector Functions

Definition of Indefinite Integral

The **indefinite integral** of $\mathbf{r}$ with respect to t is the set of all antiderivatives of $\mathbf{r}$, denoted by $\int \mathbf{r}(t) dt$. If $\mathbf{R}$ is any antiderivative of $\mathbf{r}$, then

$$\int \mathbf{r}(t) dt = \mathbf{R}(t) + \mathbf{C}$$

For the components of $\mathbf{r}(t) = f(t)\mathbf{i} + g(t)\mathbf{j} + h(t)\mathbf{k}$, we can write that

$$\int \mathbf{r}(t) dt = \left(\int f(t) dt \right) \mathbf{i} + \left(\int g(t) dt \right) \mathbf{j} + \left(\int h(t) dt \right) \mathbf{k}$$

Definition of Definite Integral

For the components of $\mathbf{r}(t) = f(t)\mathbf{i} + g(t)\mathbf{j} + h(t)\mathbf{k}$ integrable over $[a, b]$, then the **definite integral** of $\mathbf{r}$ from a to b is

$$\int_a^b \mathbf{r}(t) dt = \left(\int_a^b f(t) dt \right) \mathbf{i} + \left(\int_a^b g(t) dt \right) \mathbf{j} + \left(\int_a^b h(t) dt \right) \mathbf{k}$$

Exercises

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